TONY STARK / IRON MAN

Iron Man's armor becomes sleeker and more polished with each upgrade. The design's smooth, linear shape and accents—and with this new iteration, an abundance of arc reactors—offer a glimpse into the genius mind of Tony Stark. "With a lot of the Iron Man suits, we've always tried to be inspired by suits that have appeared in the comics before, whether aesthetically or conceptually," Concept Artist Phil Saunders says. "One of the ones people had been eager for us to tackle was the comics' Bleeding Edge armor—even if this suit doesn't have the functionality of the Bleeding Edge armor. In *Iron Man 3,* we designed the Mark 42 with a level of detail complexity because of the panel-attachment function—various plates flying onto him—which required a very fine line breakup. We were assuming that was going to be the way he continues to suit up. For both aesthetic and functional reasons, we felt it was necessary to continue that level of complexity in the Mark 45 armor, the last suit seen in *Avengers: Age of Ultron.* That suit was very organic with anatomical musculature. For this suit, the Mark 46, I wanted to take it back a little bit more toward a mechanical design while still keeping that level of musculature to it. You'll see in this design a lot of the lines flow more directly, and it has a much simpler color breakup."

Phil Saunders concept art.